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plane:

Defⁿ: A plane is a surface such that if any two points are taken on it, the straight line joining them lies wholly in the surface.

Corolla: General equation of a given point (x_1, y_1, z_1)

$$a(x - x_1) + b(y - y_1) + c(z - z_1) = 0$$

c-2: The equation of a plane passing through two points

$$(x_1, y_1, z_1) \text{ \& \& } (x_2, y_2, z_2)$$

$$(x - x_1)(y - y_2) - (x - x_2)(y - y_1) = 0$$

$$A \{ (x - x_1)(z - z_2) - (x - x_2)(z - z_1) \}$$

$$(z - z_1)$$

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c-3: plane passing through three points:

$$\begin{vmatrix} x & y & z & 1 \\ x_1 & y_1 & z_1 & 1 \\ x_2 & y_2 & z_2 & 1 \\ x_3 & y_3 & z_3 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

Ex-1: Find the equation of the plane passing through the intersection of the planes $x + 2y + 3z + 4 = 0$ and $4x + 3y + 2z + 1 = 0$ and the point $(1, 2, 3)$.

Solⁿ: Any plane through the intersection of two planes is

$$(x + 2y + 3z + 4) + k(4x + 3y + 2z + 1) = 0 \quad \text{--- (1)}$$

Since it passes through $(1, 2, 3)$

$$18 + 17k = 0 \Rightarrow k = \frac{-18}{17}$$

Putting the value in eqn ①,

$$(x+2y+3z+4) - \frac{18}{17}(4x+3y+2z+1) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 55x + 20y - 15z - 50 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 11x + 4y - 3z = 10$$

Ans

Ex-2:

Find the equation of the plane through the point $(4, -2, 1)$ and parallel to the plane whose direction ratios are $7, 2, -3$.

Soln: ~~for~~

The equation of the plane the point $(4, -2, 1)$,

$$a(x-x_1) + b(y-y_1) + c(z-z_1) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a(x-4) + b(y+2) + c(z-1) = 0$$

It is parallel to the plane whose direction ratios are $a=7, b=2, c=-3$,

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Ex-4: Find the equation of the plane passing through the lines of the intersection of the planes $2x-y=0$ and $3z-y=0$ and perpendicular to the plane $4x+5y-3z+1=0$

Soln:

The required plane,

$$(2x-y) + k(3z-y) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 2x - (1+k)y + 3kz = 0$$

It is perpendicular to $4x+5y-3z+1=0$

$$\therefore 2 \cdot 4 - (1+k) \cdot 5 + 3k(-3) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow k = \frac{-3}{19}$$

The required plane is

$$2x - y + \frac{3}{19}(3z - y) = 0$$

$$\therefore 28x - 17y + 9z = 0$$

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It passes through $(1, -2, 3)$

$$(5+6-1) + k(7-9-14) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 10 + k(-16) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow k = \frac{10}{16} = \frac{5}{8}$$

from ~~(*)~~,

$$(5x-3y-1) + \frac{5}{8}(7x-3z-19) = 0$$

$$\therefore 25x - 8y - 5z - 26 = 0$$

$$7(x-4) + 2(y+2) + 3(z-1) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 7x - 28 + 2y + 4 - 3z + 3 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 7x + 2y - 3z = 21 \quad \text{Ans}$$

Ex-3:

Find the equation of the plane through the point $(4, 0, 1)$ and parallel to the plane $4x + 3y - 12z + 6 = 0$

Soln: The required plane,

$$4x + 3y - 12z + k = 0$$

It passes through the point $(4, 0, 1)$,

$$4 \cdot 4 + 3 \cdot 0 - 12 \cdot 1 + k = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 16 - 12 + k = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow k = -4$$

The required plane is $4x + 3y - 12z - 4 = 0$

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Ex-5:

Find the equation of the plane through the points $(2, 2, 1)$ and $(9, 3, 6)$ and perpendicular to the plane $2x + 6y + 6z = 9$

Soln: The required plane is

$$\begin{vmatrix} x-x_1 & y-y_1 & z-z_1 \\ x_2-x_1 & y_2-y_1 & z_2-z_1 \\ a & b & c \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} x-2 & y-2 & z-1 \\ 9-2 & 3-2 & 6-1 \\ 2 & 6 & 6 \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} x-2 & y-2 & z-1 \\ 7 & 1 & 5 \\ 2 & 6 & 6 \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (x-2) \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 5 \\ 6 & 6 \end{vmatrix} - (y-2) \begin{vmatrix} 7 & 5 \\ 2 & 6 \end{vmatrix} + (z-1) \begin{vmatrix} 7 & 1 \\ 2 & 6 \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 3x + 9y - 5z = 9$$

Ex-6°

Find the equation of the plane through the line

$$\frac{x-2}{3} = \frac{y-3}{5} = \frac{z}{7} \text{ and passing}$$

through the point $(1, -2, 3)$.

$$\text{Soln: } \frac{x-2}{3} = \frac{y-3}{5}$$

$$\Rightarrow 5x - 10 = 3y - 9$$

$$\Rightarrow 5x - 3y - 1 = 0$$

$$\frac{x-2}{3} = \frac{z}{7}$$

$$\Rightarrow 7x - 14 = 3z$$

$$\Rightarrow 7x - 3z - 14 = 0$$

The required plane is

$$(5x - 3y - 1) + k(7x - 3z - 14) = 0$$



14/05/2026

Gradient: Let $\phi(x, y, z)$ be defined and differentiable at each point (x, y, z) in a certain region of space. Then the gradient of ϕ , written $\nabla\phi$ is defined by $\nabla\phi = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}\hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y}\hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z}\hat{k}\right)\phi(x, y, z)$

Divergent: Let $\vec{v}(x, y, z) = v_1\hat{i} + v_2\hat{j} + v_3\hat{k}$ be defined and differentiable at each point (x, y, z) in a certain region of space. Then the divergence of $\vec{v}$, written $\nabla \cdot \vec{v} = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}\hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y}\hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z}\hat{k}\right) \cdot (v_1\hat{i} + v_2\hat{j} + v_3\hat{k})$

$$= \frac{\partial v_1}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial v_2}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v_3}{\partial z}$$

Curl: If $\vec{v}(x, y, z)$ be defined vector field. Then the curl of $\vec{v}$,

written $\nabla \times \vec{v}$

$$\nabla \times \vec{v} = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{i} & \hat{j} & \hat{k} \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial}{\partial y} & \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \\ v_1 & v_2 & v_3 \end{vmatrix}$$

Ex: Suppose $A = x^2z\hat{i} - 2yz\hat{j} + xy^2\hat{k}$. Find $\nabla \times A$ at $P(1, -1, 1)$

Soln: $A = x^2z\hat{i} - 2yz\hat{j} + xy^2\hat{k}$

$$\nabla \times A = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{i} & \hat{j} & \hat{k} \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial}{\partial y} & \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \\ x^2z & -2yz & xy^2 \end{vmatrix}$$

$$= \hat{i} (2xy + 4yz) - \hat{j} (y^2 - 2xz) + \hat{k} \cdot 0$$

$$P(1, -1, 1), \quad \nabla \times \vec{A} = (-2 + 4)\hat{i} - \hat{j}(-1)$$

$$= 2\hat{i} + \hat{j}$$

Ex: Suppose $\phi(x, y, z) = 3x^2y - y^3z^2$, find $\nabla \phi$ at point $(1, -2, -1)$

$$\nabla \phi = \frac{\partial}{\partial x} (3x^2y, -y^3z^2) \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} (3x^2y, -y^3z^2) \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (3x^2y, -y^3z^2) \hat{k}$$

$$= (6xy - 0) \hat{i} + (3x^2 - 3y^2z^2) \hat{j} - 3y^3z \hat{k}$$

$$P(1, -2, -1) \quad \nabla \phi = -12\hat{i} - 9\hat{j} - 24\hat{k}$$

$$\nabla \phi(1, 3, 1) = (2 \cdot 1, 3 \cdot 1 - 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 1) \hat{i} + (1 - 4 \cdot 1 \cdot 1) \hat{j} + (3 - 8 \cdot 1 \cdot 3 \cdot 1) \hat{k}$$

$$= -6 \hat{i} - 3 \hat{j} - 21 \hat{k}$$

The unit vector in the directional derivative,

$$\vec{a} = \frac{2\hat{i} - \hat{j} - 2\hat{k}}{\sqrt{9}} = \frac{2}{3} \hat{i} - \frac{1}{3} \hat{j} - \frac{2}{3} \hat{k}$$

The required directional derivatives,

$$\vec{a} \cdot \nabla \phi = (-6\hat{i} - 3\hat{j} - 21\hat{k}) \cdot \left(\frac{2}{3} \hat{i} - \frac{1}{3} \hat{j} - \frac{2}{3} \hat{k} \right)$$

$$= -4 + 1 + 14$$

$$= 11$$

(ans)

Let $\phi = x^2 + y^2 + z^2$ and $\vec{r} = x\hat{i} + y\hat{j} + z\hat{k}$ then $\nabla \phi = 2x\hat{i} + 2y\hat{j} + 2z\hat{k}$

At $(1, 2, 3)$ the direction of the gradient is $\vec{r} = \hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}$

$$\vec{a} = \frac{\vec{r}}{|\vec{r}|} = \frac{\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}}{\sqrt{14}}$$

$$\vec{a} \cdot \nabla \phi = \frac{1}{\sqrt{14}} (\hat{i} + 2\hat{j} + 3\hat{k}) \cdot (2x\hat{i} + 2y\hat{j} + 2z\hat{k}) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{14}} (2 + 8 + 18) = \frac{28}{\sqrt{14}} = 2\sqrt{14}$$

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 # Show that, $\nabla r^n = nr^{n-2} \vec{r}$

Soln:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{L.H.S} &= \nabla r^n \\
 &= \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \hat{k} \right) \left(\sqrt{x^2 + y^2 + z^2} \right)^n \\
 &= \frac{\partial}{\partial x} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2} \hat{k} \\
 &= \frac{n}{2} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2-1} \cdot 2x \hat{i} + \frac{n}{2} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2-1} \cdot 2y \hat{j} + \frac{n}{2} (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2-1} \cdot 2z \hat{k} \\
 &= n (x^2 + y^2 + z^2)^{n/2-1} (x \hat{i} + y \hat{j} + z \hat{k}) \\
 &= n (r^2)^{n/2-1} \cdot \vec{r} \\
 &= nr^{n-2} \cdot \vec{r} \\
 &= \text{R.H.S}
 \end{aligned}$$

(Ans)

Ex: Let $\phi = xyz - 4xyz^2$. Find the directional derivative of ϕ at $P(1, 3, 1)$ in the direction of $2\hat{i} - \hat{j} - 2\hat{k}$.

Ans: we have,

$$\begin{aligned}
 \nabla \phi &= \frac{\partial}{\partial x} (xyz - 4xyz^2) \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} (xyz - 4xyz^2) \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (xyz - 4xyz^2) \hat{k} \\
 &= (yz, -4yz^2) \hat{i} + (xz, -4xz^2) \hat{j} + (xy, -8xyz) \hat{k}
 \end{aligned}$$

Ex: Find the gradient, divergence and curl of the vector $x^2z\hat{i} - y^3z^2\hat{j} + xy^2z\hat{k}$.

Soln!

Let the function, $f = x^2z\hat{i} - y^3z^2\hat{j} + xy^2z\hat{k}$

$$\text{The gradient, } \nabla f = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}\hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y}\hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z}\hat{k} \right) (x^2z, -y^3z^2, xy^2z)$$

$$= \frac{\partial}{\partial x} (x^2z, -y^3z^2, xy^2z) \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} (x^2z, -y^3z^2, xy^2z) \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (x^2z, -y^3z^2, xy^2z) \hat{k}$$

$$= (2xz, 0, y^2z) \hat{i} + (0, -3y^2z, xy^2) \hat{j} + (x^2, -2y^3z, xy^2) \hat{k}$$

$$= (2xz + y^2z) \hat{i} + (-3y^2z + xy^2) \hat{j} + (x^2 - 2y^3z + xy^2) \hat{k}$$

$$\text{The divergence } \nabla \cdot f = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}\hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y}\hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z}\hat{k} \right) \cdot (x^2z\hat{i} - y^3z^2\hat{j} + xy^2z\hat{k})$$

$$= \frac{\partial}{\partial x} (x^2z) + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} (-y^3z^2) + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (xy^2z)$$

$$= 2xz - 3y^2z + xy^2$$

$$\text{The curl, } \nabla \times f = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{i} & \hat{j} & \hat{k} \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial}{\partial y} & \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \\ x^2z & -y^3z^2 & xy^2z \end{vmatrix}$$

$$= \hat{i} \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial y} (xy^2z) - \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (-y^3z^2) \right) + \hat{j} \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} (xy^2z) - \frac{\partial}{\partial z} (x^2z) \right) + \hat{k} \cdot 0$$

$$= \hat{i} (2xy^2z + 2y^3z) - \hat{j} (y^2z - x^2)$$